Week 5
Morphology

1

internal use only

Contents

1. Types of morphemes
2. Morphemes versus morphs
3. Morphemic analysis vs. morphological analysis

2

1. Types of morphemes

1.1. Definition of morphemes

1.2. Types of morphemes

3

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1. Definition of Morphemes 1

- **A morpheme** is the …….. …….. unit in a language.
- Like the phoneme, the morpheme refers to either a class of forms or an …….. from the concrete forms of language.

E.g.:

- Grammatical morphemes: ***a, in, can, plural morpheme, present tense morpheme.***
- Lexical morpheme: ***book, eat, "-er", "re-"***

4

1. Definition of Morphemes 1

Characteristics	
Internally ……	it cannot be further subdivided or analyzed into smaller meaningful units.
Internally ……..	nothing can be interposed in a morpheme
Externally ……	it has positional mobility or free distribution, occurring in various context

5

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1. Definition of Morphemes 1

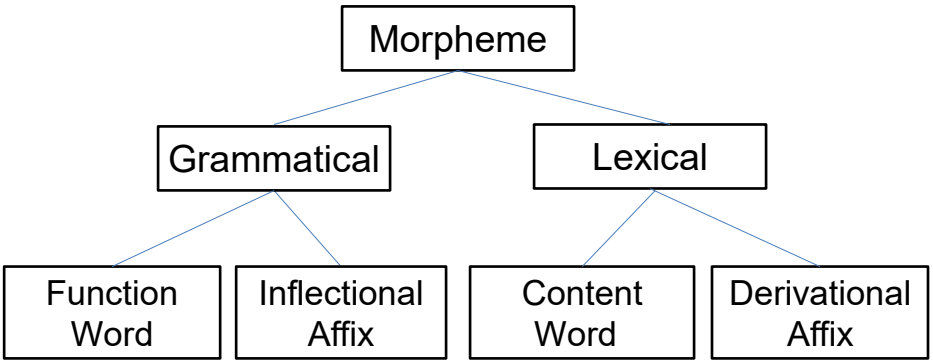
- Identify the morphemes in the following sentence:

  The police reopened the investigation.

6

2. Types of morphemes

1



This classification is based primarily on ……....

7

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2. Types of morphemes

1

Grammatical morphemes	Lexical morphemes
Express a ……of common meanings, or express relations within the sentence.	Express lexical / dictionary meaning.
Their occurrence is …….... by the grammar of the sentence .	Categorized into word classes: *noun, verb, adjective, adverb*
Constitute closed word classes. Can be exhaustively listed.	Constitute open categories i.e. new members can be …….
Are parts of words i.e. *inflectional affixes,* or small but independent 'function words' belonging to the minor word classes i.e. *prepositions*.	Are generally independent words (free roots) or parts of words (derivational affixes and bound roots).

8

Examples

Grammatical morphemes
- Function words:
- Pronouns, Prepositions, Auxiliary verbs, Conjunctions, Determiners

- Inflectional affixes:
- "-s / es": Singular/Plural;
- "-er", "-est": Comparison
- "-ing", "-ed": Participle

Lexical morphemes
- Content words:
- Nouns
- Verbs
- Adjectives
- Adverbs

- Derivational affixes
- Prefixes: "re-, un- , dis-
- Suffixes:
  - Noun suffixes:
  - Verb suffixes:
  - Adjective suffixes:
  - Adverb suffixes:

9

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2. Morphemes versus morphs

2.1. Definition of Morphs

2.2. Types of Morphs

2.3. Morphemes vs. Morphs

10

1. Definition of Morphs

2

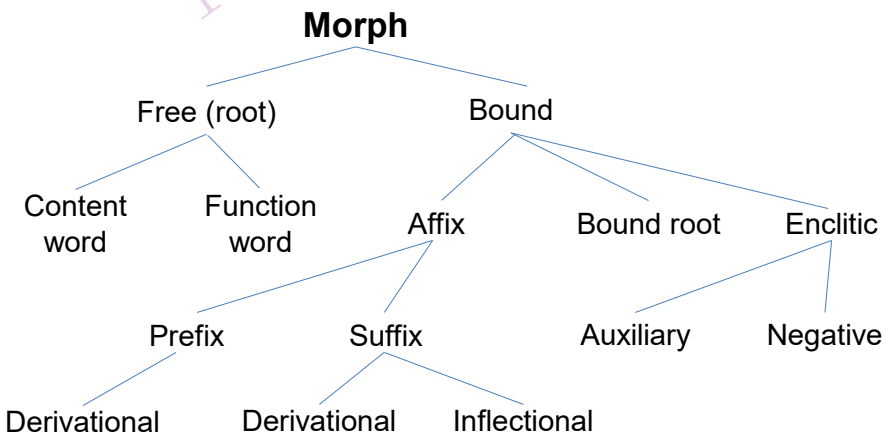
- **A morph** is the …… realization of a morpheme.
- This classification is based primarily on …… .

11

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2. Types of morphs

2



This classification is based primarily on …… .

12

2. Types of morphs

2

Free morphs	Bound morphs
Can stand by themselves as single words.	Cannot normally stand alone and are always …….. another morph.
Is always a **root** morpheme.	
Carries the principal lexical or grammatical …… .	Doesn't carry the ……. meaning.
E.g. open, tour, un***avoid***ably	E.g. re-, -ist, -ed, -s, -'s
May …… other free or bound morphemes. E.g.: unavoidably, overgrown, Disheartened, reclassify.	**Roots** are occasionally **bound morphs** (or bound roots) **.** E.g.: **-vert** in convert, revert **- mit**: in transmit, permit **- ceive**: in conceive, receive

13

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Examples

2

Undressed

Un- **dress** **-ed**

14

2. Types of morphs

2

Derivational affixes	Inflectional affixes
Can either be a …… or ……..	Is always a ……
Can be more than …….. ~ per word.	Maybe **only** …… ~ per word.
A particular ~ may attach to only a …… number of roots.	A particular ~ may attach to all or most members of a certain word class.
Function: - Convert one part of speech to another (……). - Change the meaning of the root (……...).	**Function:** - Indicate grammatical meaning/ aspect of a word.
Always …… an inflectional affix.	Always occur ……

15

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2. Types of morphs

2

- **An enclitic** is a kind of ……, a bound form which derives from an …… word and must be attached to the preceding word.
- **Two kinds of enclitics**:
  - Auxiliaries: attached to the preceding subject (He'll, she'd, I've, You're, I'm)
  - Negative *–n't:* attached to the preceding auxiliary (won't, mustn't, hasn't, wasn't)

This classification is based primarily on **MEANING**.

16

2. Types of morphs

2

A Root ≠	**A Base**,	which is a ROOT + associated derivational affixes, to which …… are added.
	A Stem,	which is a ROOT + associated derivational affixes, to which …… are added.

17

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Root, Base, Stem

2

en – gage – ment – s

18

Morphological description

- Identify 11 morphemes and their types in the following sentence:

The child's wildness shocked the teachers.

19

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3. **Morphemic** analysis vs. **Morphological** analysis

- Not always a …… correspondence between morph and morphemes.
- Morphemes can combine or be realized in a number of different ways.

20

3. **Morphemic** analysis vs. **Morphological** analysis

- **Morphological analysis**: words are analyzed into …….. (following formal divisions).
- **Morphemic analysis**: words are analyzed into …….. (recognizing the abstract units of meaning present).

21

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Nouns

3

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Writers	3 morphs	3 morphemes
	writ/er/s	{WRITE} + {ER}+ {pl}
Authors	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	author/s	……
Mice	1 morph	2 morphemes
	……	{MOUSE} + {pl}
Fish	1 morph	2 morphemes
	fish	{FISH} + {pl}

22

Nouns

3

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Children	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	Child/ren	{CHILD} + {pl}
Teeth	1 morph	2 morphemes
	teeth	{TOOTH} + {pl}
Man's	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	man/ s	{MAN} + {poss}
Men's	2 morphs	3 morphemes
	men/ s	{MAN} + {pl} + {poss}

23

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Nouns

3

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Sheep	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Sheep	{SHEEP} + {pl}
		{SHEEP} + {sg}

NOTE:
If a morpheme is postulated for singular, we can account for number systematically

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Author	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Author	{AUTHOR} + {sg}

Adjectives

3

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Smaller	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	small/er	{SMALL} + {comp}
Smallest	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	Small/est	{SMALL} + {supl}
better	1 morph	2 morphemes
	better	……
best	1 morph	2 morphemes
	best	{GOOD} + {supl}
Good	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Good	{GOOD} + {pos}

25

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Verbs

3

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
worked	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	work/ed	…… ……
wrote	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Wrote	{WRITE} + {past}
Written	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Written	{WRITE} + {pastprt}
Working	2 morphs	2 morphemes
	Work/ing	{work} + {prsprt}
		3 morphemes
		……

26

Verbs

3

NOTE:

-ing verbal forms can be analyzed as present participle or gerund.

Since gerunds are functioning as nouns, they may be pluralized.

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Sittings	3 morphs	3 morphemes
	sitt/ing/s	{SIT} + {gerund} + {pl}

27

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Verbs

3

NOTE:

A morpheme need to be postulated {pres} to account coherently for the distinction ***past*** vs ***present***.

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
Work	1 morph	2 morphemes
	work	{WORK} + {pres}
write	1 morph	2 morphemes
	Write	{WRITE} + {pres}

28

Pronouns

3

	Morphological Analysis	Morphemic Analysis
we	1 morph	3 morphemes
	We	{1st p} + {pl} + {nomn}
him	1 morph	4 morphemes
	him	{3rd p} + {sg} + {m} + {obj}
its	2 morphs	4 morphemes
	It/s	{3rd p} + {sg} + {n} + {poss}

NOTE:
Nomn = nominative case
Obj = objective case

29

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